

Prompt challenge

Ceardlann 2 — Dúshlán na leide

OBJECTIVE

Start with a deliberately weak prompt and improve it step by step, one rung at a time.

A better prompt can make the answer more useful. It does not make the answer more true.

TIME	GROUP	OUTPUT
25 minutes	5 groups of 3	7 items

CONNECTION TO THE MORNING

A language model generates likely continuations from the information you give it. Give it a better brief (audience, purpose, tone, facts, format) and the output usually gets more useful. It does not become more true — prediction is still not understanding, and fluent is still not the same as factual.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN — WHAT NEVER GOES IN

The same instinct from Mary's cybersecurity section applies here — what are we handing over, and to whom?

- Confidential information
- Personal information
- Customer information
- Commercially sensitive information
- Passwords or credentials
- Private organisational information
- Restricted documents
- Anything organisational policy says must not leave the building

Use public, fictional or anonymised information instead.

WHAT YOU NEED TO DO

Turn the page and climb the four rungs, running the prompt in an AI tool at each stage you can.

WORKSHOP 2 · DO THE ACTIVITY

Keep to exactly — do not paraphrase

“If a detail is missing, leave a clearly marked gap rather than inventing it.”

“At the end, list any Irish terms you were unsure about.”

Rung 1

“Write a newsletter about our business.” Run it.

WHAT WAS USEFUL? WHAT WAS MISSING? WHAT COULD BE WRONG?

Rung 2 — add: Audience, Purpose

Run it again.

WHAT CHANGED?

Rung 3 — add: Tone, Length, Key information

Run it again.

WHAT CHANGED?

WORKSHOP 2 · DO THE ACTIVITY (CONTINUED)

Rung 4 — add: Format, Limits, Source discipline, Language

Run it again — this is your improved prompt.

WHAT CHANGED?

WHICH AI TOOL?

Use whichever suitable AI tool you already have access to: ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Claude, Gemini, or another approved generative AI tool.

This is not about which product is best. It is about deciding when AI is appropriate, communicating a task clearly, checking the output, and retaining human responsibility. No paid account and no new account are required.

No access on the day? Work with another participant, or use a facilitator-provided example.

EXAMPLE ONLY — not the expected answer

RUNG 1: Generic prompt → generic output.

RUNG 2: Audience + purpose → more targeted output.

RUNG 3: Tone + length + information → more specific output.

RUNG 4: Format + limits + source discipline + language → more controlled output.

A better prompt does not guarantee a correct answer. The AI may still invent information, misunderstand an instruction, produce poor Irish, make unsupported claims, or miss context. You still need to check the result.

WORKSHOP 2 · FINISH THE ACTIVITY

Your expected output

1. ORIGINAL WEAK PROMPT

2. IMPROVED PROMPT

3. ORIGINAL OUTPUT (IN A SENTENCE)

4. IMPROVED OUTPUT (IN A SENTENCE)

5. ONE THING THAT IMPROVED

6. ONE THING THAT REMAINED WRONG

7. ONE THING YOU WOULD CHECK BEFORE USING THE RESULT

NEXT: Reflection 2 — What changed?

What changed, which instruction mattered most, whether errors disappeared, what the AI still misunderstood, what you would check, and whether you would use the prompt again.

A better prompt can improve an answer. It does not remove the need for judgement.